

boxes, there is no need for bevels, rather clear spacing and typography is used for content presentation and segregation.

Is the new Windows 8 UI better? That's a point of much argument and the fact is, the answer will be different for different people. Even if we assume that the new Windows 8 UI is brilliant, there is still great value in familiarity. Many Linux distros still try to use the interface conven-



Whoa! For a second I thought I was holding a real bookshelf

tions of Windows, because that is what most people are familiar with. Those who have used the traditional Windows interface for a long time are used to how it looks and works, and they may find the UI changes discordant.

Windows 8 is however the first in this new brand of Windows, and some teething problems are to be expected. What is up to users is whether they are willing to put

up with these issues for the other benefits it provides. Getting back to the point on touch, it is something Windows 8 does well. An example of how far touch support goes in Windows 8 is the boot and login process. Windows 8 goes as far as to give you a mouse or touch driven boot screen, so if you have multiple operating systems, you will be able to boot to them right from the boot screen using touch.

Once the system boots, logging in is the next pain point, but Windows 8 has your back here as well. Rather than log in using a clumsy on-screen keyboard, Microsoft has developed a new gesture based login system that lets you log in using gestures performed over a picture of your choice.

To the Cloud and Beyond

Windows 8 also finally takes the cloud a lot more seriously. The latest OS goes as far as to let you log in using an online Microsoft account rather than a standard local account (although the latter is obviously still an option) and having a Microsoft account linked has some benefits as we will go on to explain.

If you have a linked Microsoft account, one of the major benefits is that Windows can automatically synchronise a number of Windows settings and personalisations to the cloud. For example, it will sync you desktop themes,